

151 Build a wormery

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Earthworms are amazing tunnelers, creating rich compost as they go and adding oxygen and nutrients to the soil. Build this wormery and watch them at work.

What you need

- 3-sided frame, 12 x 8 x 2 in (30 x 20 x 5 cm)
- 2 clear plastic sheets
- 4 bulldog clips • Compost, soil, sand, leaves • Worms



1 Ask an adult to help you make the frame. Cut two sheets of clear plastic almost the same width as the wood.



2 Glue the sheets to either side of the frame. Secure the ends with the bulldog clips. The clips also give the worm farm stability, so leave them in place.

3 Stand your wormery on a tray. Fill the gap with alternate layers of compost, sand, and soil. Lightly moisten the layers, then add the worms. Cover the top with leaves.



4 Drape the wormery with a cloth and put it in a cool, dark place. After a few days, check to see how busy your little wrigglers have been!

152 Is it a head or a tail?

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You can tell which end of a worm is which by finding its saddle—the thick band that forms in adult worms. A worm's head is near the saddle. With young worms you have to see which end moves forward.

